ANTI-CORRUPTION COMMISSION

COMMISSION MEETING FORM

MEETING NO.	9th Commission Meeting
DATE:	07 January 2026
TIME:	02:00 PM
VENUE:	*Druk Dradhir Khang*

#	AGENDA & DISCUSSION	DECISION
1	Monthly update on the Escrow Account – DoPS *EMD apprised the Commission on the status of the Escrow Account with the opening balance of Nu. 35,378,833.96 and closing balance of Nu. 35,198,029.96 for the month of December 2025.* *Additionally, CFD presented a proposed prioritized list of vulnerable professions for enforcement of mandatory IVR, in line with the performance targets identified in the FY 2025-2026. The proposed prioritization comprises the following categories:* 1. *Forest and Environment Services Personnel;* 2. *Agriculture and Livestock Personnel;* 3. *Healthcare Services related Personnel;* 4. *Election Personnel;* 5. *Procurement, Engineer, and Accounts Personnel;* 6. *Human Resource Personnel;* 7. *Land Record Services related Personnel;* 8. *Banking Services related Personnel;* 9. *Export and Import Services related Personnel;* 10. *Tourism Industry Services related Personnel;* 11. *Hydropower Services related Personnel;* 12. *Sports related Personnel;* 13. *Entertainment related Personnel; and* 14. *Legal and Judiciary Personnel.* *It was noted that the above prioritization is informed by the findings of the Scoping Study Report on Corruption Vulnerability Assessment of Public Services.*	**Noted.** **Directed to further refine the prioritization of professions by rationalizing the associated risk levels for each category. In doing so, CFD shall consult with the ED of DoPE to ensure a common understanding and consistent approach.** **Furthermore, directed that the category of '*Election personnel*' be revised to '*Political candidates*', recognizing their heightened susceptibility to corruption risks.** **In addition, the Commission advised exploring alternative terminology to replace the term "*vulnerable*" with a view to attaching a more positive and constructive framing while retaining the intended risk-based focus.**
2	Debrief on Thematic training for Agriculture Extension Supervisors – DoPE *Education Division (ED) apprised the Commission on the thematic training conducted for Agriculture*	**Noted.**

	Extension Supervisors from 20 Dzongkhags, delivered across four regions and covering a total of 179 officials. The target officials were identified as vulnerable based on findings from the Scoping Study Report on Corruption Vulnerability Assessment of Public Services. *Additionally, the Acting Director updated the Commission on the status of preparations for the commemoration of the upcoming National Anti-Corruption Day (NACD) at the Phuentsholing Regional Office (PRO). In this regard, the meeting noted the need to strategically optimize participation, particularly by enhancing youth engagement, given that parallel programs will be conducted to observe the Birth Anniversary of His Majesty The King.*	
3	Draft agenda for Bilateral Meeting with the OAG – LD & DoI *LD and DoI apprised the Commission on the draft agenda for the Bilateral Meeting with the OAG, scheduled to be held on 09 Friday 2025 at 11:00 AM, and to be hosted at the ACC.*	**Endorsed the draft agenda with the directive to following additional agenda items:** - **operationalization of Justice Sector Digital Blueprint.** - **media release on cases where judgment have been rendered.**
4	Proposed agenda items for Tripartite Forum – LD & PPD *LD and PPD apprised the Commission on the proposed agenda items for discussion at the Forum as follows:* - *prosecution and conviction of money laundering cases, particularly in view of the upcoming Mutual Evaluation Review (MER) in 2027;* - *issuance of Powers of Attorney (PoA) to profit-making agencies to prosecute cases upon completion of investigations;* - *status of implementation of the TRUST system;* - *sensitization on the SoP for missing of person to other law enforcement agencies; and* - *Rapid Response Teams (RRT) during audit processes.* *In addition, Commissioner A. Karma Rinzin informed the Commission of his plan to visit and meet with the ACC team at the GMC while en route to Tsirang for the Mandatory Training, and subsequently to PRO in connection with the upcoming National Anti-Corruption Day (NACD). The visit is intended to understand ground realities and identify necessary way forward measures.*	**Endorsed the proposed draft agenda items and directed PPD to coordinate the volunteering service at the GMC either prior to or following the Tripartite Forum, as appropriate, given the tentative scheduling around the same period.** **Noted.**

5	Institutional collaboration request from the ACC Maldives – PPD *PPD apprised the Commission on the pending request from the ACC Maldives to share best practices related to investigation management, asset disclosure mechanism, and other related anti-corruption measures. To this, PPD proposed to initiate an introductory meeting with the officials from the ACC Maldives to better understand their specific needs, expectations, and preferred modalities for engagement and knowledge sharing.*	**Endorsed to be initiated at the PPD level.**
6	Request of data for Socio-Economic Indicators from the NSB – PPD *PPD apprised the Commission on the recent practice of sharing quarterly complaints data with the National Statistics Bureau (NSB), noting that data for two quarters have been shared to date. PPD further informed that the NSB has now requested the disaggregated complaints data by Dzongkhag.* *In this regard, PPD submitted the following concerns for the Commission's consideration:* - *risk of data inconsistency, as the complaints statistics published in the Socio-Economic Indicators (SEI) may differ from those presented in the ACC Annual Report, which undergoes more rigorous categorization, authentication, and validation processes. The Annual Report consolidates complaints received through multiple sources, including complainants, agency referrals, offshoot cases, and proactive intelligence, which may not be fully captured in the quarterly data shared with NSB, potentially resulting in two differing complaint figures for the same reporting year.* - *timing and decision-cycle mismatch, as complaints are assessed and decided on a weekly basis. Complaints received toward the end of a reporting period (e.g., on a Friday) may not yet have been assessed or decided but could nonetheless be included in data submitted to the NSB within the same cycle. When such complaints are subsequently assessed and captured in the next reporting period, this creates a risk of double counting, leading to inconsistencies between provisional and finalized complaint statistics.* - *confidentiality concerns, as disaggregating complaints data by Dzongkhag may*	**Endorsed and directed to formally convey the decision.**

	compromise anonymity and lead to unnecessary or unobjective public discourse. - *statutory considerations, as the ACC's Annual Report is made public only after deliberation in Parliament, and the publication of complaints statistics in the SEI may undermine this established statutory practice.* *In view of the above concerns, PPD apprised the Commission of the proposal to discontinue the sharing of complaints data with the NSB.*	
7	Request for contact person for ACA Effectiveness Dashboard Access from the IACA – PPD *PPD apprised the Commission that the International Anti-Corruption Academy (IACA) will be publishing findings on the measurement of the effectiveness of Anti-Corruption Agencies (ACAs). For this purpose, IACA has subscribed to an analytical software platform and will provide one institutional access to each participating ACA to enable access to the dashboard.* *In this regard, IACA has requested the nomination of one designated official from each ACA to access the institutional-level dashboard. PPD therefore sought the Commission's guidance on whether such access should be maintained at the level of the PPD or retained at the Commission level.*	**Directed to be maintained at the PPD.**
8	Others - Request for handover of ICT systems to the GovTech Agency *Upon follow-up with the Chief, Digital Service Operation & Maintenance Division, GovTech Agency, it was advised that the request is to those agencies without dedicated ICT Focal. However, the agencies are supposed to share the list of systems hosted in the GDC and at the agency premises.* - UNCAC Review Report *Recognizing that the UNCAC Review constitutes a comprehensive compliance assessment of anti-corruption policies, laws, strategies, and measures, including stakeholder collaboration, the Commission highlighted the importance of publishing the current Executive Summary and report whenever available for broader public dissemination so as to enhance public*	**Noted.** **PPD to consult legal regarding publication of the reports in the ACC website.**

	understanding of the scope and substance of the ACC's work.	
	- National Anti-Corruption Strategy *In keeping with the emerging priorities and evolving corruption dynamics, the meeting discussed the need for a comprehensive National Anti-Corruption Strategy that clearly articulates the focus areas going forward and delineates the respective roles and responsibilities of key stakeholders. This includes the ACC as the lead agency, alongside the Executive, Judiciary, Legislature, Armed Forces, State-Owned Enterprises and Corporations, Media, Civil Society Organizations, and the Private Sector, in collectively advancing and sustaining the national anti-corruption agenda.*	**PPD to present a proposal on the way forward.**
	- Budget overview of the EU-UNDP project under JSSP II *Considering the importance and magnitude of the Justice Sector Digital Blueprint, the Commission emphasized the need to mobilize additional resources to support its effective implementation. In this regard, the Commission discussed the need to review the allocation of budgets under the current EU-UNDP project for the Justice Sector Strategic Plan Phase II (JSSPP II), with a view to identifying possible areas for rationalization and optimization.*	**PPD to present the budget overview.**
	- Meeting with the MoESD, MoIT, MoENR, and Department of Law & Order (DLO) under MoHA *The Commission discussed the need to coordinate meeting with the Hon'ble Ministers of MoESD, MoIT, and MoENR as well as the DG of DLO in view of the vulnerabilities and targeted support required for strengthening anti-corruption programs in their respective sectors.*	**PPD to coordinate the meetings.**
	- TI-CPI score *In order to ensure targeted interventions and address gaps identified through the TI-CPI, the Commission underscored the need to undertake an in-depth analysis of all data sources used in constructing Bhutan's CPI score. Such an analysis would enable the Commission to strategically position its interventions, including focused stakeholder engagement, with a view to achieving a*	**PPD to make detailed presentation on the TI-CPI.**

	measurable and positive impact on Bhutan's TI-CPI performance. - Meeting with the senior editors from Media House *The Commission discussed the need to engage with senior editors from media houses to not only sensitize them on the ACC's standards operating procedures in discharging its mandate but also to clarify the Commission's expectations of the media in supporting and augmenting the national anti-corruption agenda.* - Quarterly Publications by the Regional Offices *Acknowledging the insightfulness of the quarterly publications shared by the TRO and PRO, the Commission noted the need for wider public dissemination to enhance understanding of the ACC's work at the regional level. However, it was also observed that the current content is largely internally oriented and may therefore need to be reviewed and adapted to better suit public consumption.*	**PPD to coordinate the meeting towards later part of FY.** **PPD to discuss with the Regional Offices.**

Commissioner **Commissioner** **Chairperson**